

# ICELAND

## Key Country Details Table

| Detail             | Information                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Full Name          | Republic of Iceland                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Short Form         | Iceland                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Capital            | Reykjavík                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Region (UN)        | Western European and Others Group (WEOG)                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Government Type    | Parliamentary Republic                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Head of State      | President Halla Tómasdóttir (elected 2024)                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Head of Government | Prime Minister Katrín Jakobsdóttir                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Currency           | Icelandic Króna (ISK)                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| UN Member Since    | 19 November 1946                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| MUN Standing       | Iceland is recognized for its strong commitment to human rights, gender equality, environmental sustainability, and multilateral cooperation. It actively participates in UN bodies and contributes to peacekeeping and development initiatives. |

## Book Recommendations

| Title                                                      | Author(s)                 | Why It's Relevant                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Iceland's Foreign Policy: A Small State Perspective</i> | Baldur Thorhallsson       | Analyzes Iceland's approach to international relations and its role within multilateral organizations like the UN. |
| <i>Gender Equality in Iceland: The Role of the State</i>   | Guðbjörg Ríkey Thoroddsen | Explores Iceland's policies and achievements in promoting gender equality, aligning with UNCSW objectives.         |

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Iceland and the International Criminal Court: A Study in International Law</i> | Guðmundur Eiríksson          | Discusses Iceland's engagement with international legal institutions, relevant to discussions in UNHRC and UNSC contexts.                |
| <i>Environmental Governance in Iceland: A Nordic Perspective</i>                  | Áslaug Ásgeirsdóttir         | Examines Iceland's environmental policies and their alignment with global sustainability goals, pertinent to ECOSOC and WHO discussions. |
| <i>Children's Rights in Iceland: Implementation and Challenges</i>                | Margrét María Sigurðardóttir | Provides insight into Iceland's efforts to uphold children's rights, relevant to UNICEF-related topics.                                  |

## Iceland: UNHRC & Human Rights Resources

| Source Name                                           | Link                                                                                                                                                                                  | Why It's Useful                                                                   |
|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <u>UN Digital Library – Iceland UNHRC Submissions</u> | <a href="https://digitallibrary.un.org/search?cc=Meetings&amp;f1=author&amp;p1=Iceland">https://digitallibrary.un.org/search?cc=Meetings&amp;f1=author&amp;p1=Iceland</a>             | Repository of Iceland's written and oral submissions to the Human Rights Council. |
| <u>UN Web TV – Iceland at Human Rights Council</u>    | <a href="https://webtv.un.org/search?term=iceland%20human%20rights%20council">https://webtv.un.org/search?term=iceland%20human%20rights%20council</a>                                 | Video records of Iceland's statements at HRC sessions.                            |
| Universal Periodic Review – Iceland                   | <a href="https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/is-index">https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/is-index</a>                                                                         | Iceland's reporting and peer-review recommendations under UPR cycles.             |
| Amnesty International – Iceland Country Reports       | <a href="https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/europe-and-central-asia/iceland/report-iceland/">https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/europe-and-central-asia/iceland/report-iceland/</a> | Reviews civil rights, gender, asylum, and anti-discrimination laws in Iceland.    |
| Human Rights Watch – Iceland                          | <a href="https://www.hrw.org/europe/central-asia/iceland">https://www.hrw.org/europe/central-asia/iceland</a>                                                                         | Investigates Iceland's                                                            |

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|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Overview                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                           | approach to refugee protection, LGBTQ+ rights, and law enforcement. |
| Freedom House – Iceland Profile                              | <a href="https://freedomhouse.org/country/iceland/freedom-world/2023">https://freedomhouse.org/country/iceland/freedom-world/2023</a>                                                     | Global assessment of political rights and civil liberties.          |
| European Commission against Racism and Intolerance – Iceland | <a href="https://www.coe.int/en/web/european-commission-against-racism-and-intolerance/iceland">https://www.coe.int/en/web/european-commission-against-racism-and-intolerance/iceland</a> | External review of Iceland's anti-racism and equality enforcement.  |

| Title                                 | Link                                         | Relevance                                                                                     |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Universal Periodic Review – Iceland   | <a href="#">OHCHR UPR Central Page</a>       | Official UPR state, NGO, and UN submissions ( <a href="https://www.ohchr.org">ohchr.org</a> ) |
| OHCHR Iceland Country Page            | <a href="#">OHCHR</a>                        | Central portal for Iceland-related human rights mechanisms                                    |
| UNHCR Iceland Fact Sheet – Sept 2024  | <a href="#">ReliefWeb PDF</a>                | Covers refugee numbers and protection programming                                             |
| UNHCR Global Focus – Iceland profile  | <a href="#">UNHCR Global Focus</a>           | Overview of refugee stats and policy                                                          |
| UNHCR Europe Fact Sheet Sept 2024     | <a href="#">UNHCR Fact Sheet</a>             | Humanitarian inclusion and cash assistance                                                    |
| Refugee/employer resources – Iceland  | <a href="#">UNHCR Europe Employers Page</a>  | Data on refugees, employment inclusion                                                        |
| Freedom on the Net 2024 – Iceland     | <a href="#">Freedom House Net Report</a>     | Iceland tops global ranking for internet freedom                                              |
| Freedom in the World 2024 – Iceland   | <a href="#">Freedom House Country Report</a> | Confirms robust civil and political rights                                                    |
| Human Rights Watch – Iceland overview | <a href="#">HRW Country Page</a>             | Examines Icelandic human rights policies                                                      |

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|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Amnesty International – Iceland     | <a href="#">Amnesty Iceland</a>               | Covers rights, campaigns, civil society activism   |
| Digital migration tech risks        | <a href="#">Amnesty on migration tech PDF</a> | Highlights digital rights issues in refugee policy |
| Nordic leadership in UNHRC          | <a href="#">HRW analysis</a>                  | Iceland led on Philippines resolution              |
| Government Statements repository    | <a href="#">Iceland Gov Statements</a>        | Tracks UPR, HRC, ASEAN positions                   |
| Stateless and migrant data          | <a href="#">UNHCR Employer Page</a>           | Info on stateless people, migrants                 |
| Global refugee trends context       | <a href="#">UNICEF Migration Data</a>         | Context for Iceland's refugee work                 |
| Freedom in the World 2025 – Iceland | <a href="#">Freedom House 2025</a>            | Confirms stable democratic freedoms                |
| Freedom on the Net 2024 report PDF  | <a href="#">Freedom House PDF</a>             | Global context; verifying Iceland's top status     |

## Unique Aspects of Iceland's UNHRC Engagement

- 1. Nordic Leadership on Country-Specific Resolutions:** Iceland took the lead on the Philippines resolution at the UN Human Rights Council, highlighting its commitment to proactive global advocacy.
- 2. Top-Ranked Internet Freedom:** Iceland is consistently #1 globally in "Freedom on the Net," with transparent digital governance.
- 3. Refugee Integration & Employment Focus:** The UNHCR is running some fantastic programs that are helping more than 8,800 refugees find jobs.
- 4. E-Participation & AI Governance:** Digital democratic tools like e-petitions and AI oversight are now part of the discussions in the Universal Periodic Review (UPR).
- 5. Civil Society Strength:** Amnesty, Human Rights Watch, and various national NGOs play a significant role in shaping policy and contributing to UPR submissions.
- 6. UPR Transparency:** Iceland offers mid-term updates along with open access to UPR records and videos.

7. **Refugee and Stateless Population Data:** The detailed data from UNHCR, shows around 2,200 asylum seekers and about 30 stateless residents.
  8. **Digital-Tech Impacts on Migration:** Identified digital weaknesses in systems for refugee registration and monitoring.
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